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REPORT | NOVEMBER 13, 2019

EUROPE'S UNAUTHORIZED IMMIGRANT POPULATION PEAKS IN 2016,
THEN LEVELS OFF

Appendix E: Updated unauthorized immigrant population estimates for Europe and the United Kingdom, 2014-2017

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Editorial note to readers (March 19, 2025):

This project estimated the number of unauthorized immigrants living in 32 European countries during the mid- to late-2010s. We used what were then the best available data sources from different governments and from the European Union. After our report was published in November 2019, researchers at the University of Oxford's Migration Observatory [identified a problem](#) with the official data from the United Kingdom's Office for National Statistics (ONS) on the number of legal immigrants residing in the

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Europe in 2017 and other years. The updated estimates for the number of unauthorized immigrants in 2017 (without waiting asylum seekers) are 700,000-900,000 for the UK and 2.8 million-3.5 million for Europe. [Updated estimates can be found in this table but are not reflected elsewhere in this report.](#)

Updated unauthorized immigrant population estimates for Europe and the United Kingdom, 2014-2017

Estimated number of unauthorized immigrants in thousands by country of residence

	2017		2016		2015		2014	
	Low	High	Low	High	Low	High	Low	High
Estimates without waiting asylum seekers:								
United Kingdom	700	900	800	1,000	700	900	700	900
Total EU-EFTA	2,800	3,500	2,900	3,900	2,200	3,500	2,300	2,900
Estimates with waiting asylum seekers:								
United Kingdom	700	900	800	1,000	700	900	800	900
Total EU-EFTA	3,800	4,500	4,000	5,000	3,200	4,600	2,900	3,400

Note: All numbers are rounded. "Low" and "High" show the range of estimates for the unauthorized immigrant population. The total number of unauthorized immigrants with waiting asylum seekers includes asylum seekers waiting for a decision on their case. Read the original report for definitions, methodology and rounding rules.
Source: Pew Research Center estimates based on Eurostat and European labor force survey data. Updated on March 18, 2025, to reflect new data for the United Kingdom.
"Europe's Unauthorized Immigrant Population Peaks in 2016, Then Levels Off"

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-  Report PDF
-  Fact sheets: Country-specific data on unauthorized immigrant populations
-  How Pew Research Center estimated the number of unauthorized immigrants in Europe
-  Summary of findings: (English)
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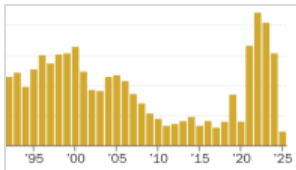


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